

Joint OGC-OSGeo-ASF Code Sprint:

Know before you go

The Joint OGC-OSGeo-ASF Code Sprint will take place 27-29 January 2026 in Fort Collins, Colorado USA.

GENERAL INFORMATION

VENUE

USGS Science Center | 2150 Centre Avenue, Building C, Fort Collins, CO USA 80526

<https://maps.app.goo.gl/9ZEGcP8b298mNKE9A>

ACCOMODATIONS

- **Hilton Fort Collins**, 425 W Prospect Rd, Fort Collins, CO 80526 (0.7 mile / 1 km from venue)
- **Best Western University Inn**, 914 S College Ave, Fort Collins, CO 80524 (2 km from venue)
- Many other options across Fort Collins, but generally not an easy walk in January

ATTIRE

The dress code is casual.

TIMING

The Code Sprint will run from 0900 – 1700 (UTC-7) in the venue. Additional, ad hoc discussions and work can continue into the evening at nearby breweries or restaurants.

LOGISTICS

Badges can be picked up just inside the entrance to the venue starting 30 minutes before the code sprint each day. Please bring a photo ID in the form of a Passport or Driver's License.

- You should have already provided your dietary and special requirements when you registered, but feel free to reach out to us at registration@ogc.org if anything has changed related to your special dietary, physical, vision, or hearing needs, etc.
- Coffee breaks will be provided throughout the code sprint. Lunch will be provided each days.

LOCAL INFORMATION

GETTING TO FORT COLLINS

The USGS Science Center is in the center of Fort Collins near Colorado State University. Fort Collins is approximately 62 miles / 100 km North of Denver.

AIR

[Denver International Airport](#) (DEN) is approximately 70 miles / 113 km from Fort Collins.

- Rental cars are widely available, but may be more expensive than one would expect due to the ski season.
- Ride share with Uber and Lyft are readily available and will cost approximately \$120 each way.
- Two commercial bus services run between the airport and Fort Collins and both stop at the Colorado State University Transit Center (approximately 10-15 minute walk to the Hilton Hotel):

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- [Landline](#)
- [Groome Transportation](#) - also offers pickup/dropoff at the Hilton Hotel

TRANSPORTATION

Fort Collins is more pedestrian-friendly than many U.S. cities and is rated as a [Platinum Bicycle Friendly City by the League of American Bicyclists](#). Rental bikes and scooters are widely available, many roads have dedicated bicycle lanes, and numerous pedestrian/bicycle trails cross the city.

Public bus transportation is free. The venue lies just a two-minute walk from the Spring Creek Station on the MAX bus line, which runs North-South the length of the city and connects to other bus lines at several points.

WEATHER

The weather in Fort Collins in late January can be highly variable, with average highs of 44°F (7°C) and lows of 14°F (-10°C). Do not be surprised by considerably warmer weather but still be prepared for wind and/or snow. [Check the weather forecast here](#).

Note that the elevation of Fort Collins is approximately 5000 ft / 1500 m and the humidity is generally very low – do not feel bad if you need to catch your breath more than normal. The city is semi-arid, so be prepared to drink plenty of water.

VISITING FORT COLLINS

Fort Collins is beautifully situated against the foothills of the Rocky Mountains. The city and nearby area abound in outdoor activities, but being a college town, there are numerous cultural offerings as well. The historic downtown offers a vibrant collection of restaurants, breweries, and shops. More information can be found at [Visit Fort Collins](#).

Fort Collins is located less than an hour from Rocky Mountain National Park and just over an hour from two small ski areas (Eldora and Snowy Range). Larger ski resorts are as close as two hours by car.

QUESTIONS

Reach out to us with any questions or concerns via email at registration@ogc.org.

BEFORE YOU TAKE OFF

Visas

Many foreign travelers need visas to enter the United States. To determine your needs, visit the U.S. [Department of State's website](#).

Electricity

The U.S. uses 110 to 120 volts AC and Types A and B power plugs. It's best to purchase an outlet adapter before traveling to the United States.

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AT THE AIRPORT

Immigration and Customs

Denver International Airport has a generally efficient immigration hall. Please note that it can be a long walk from the airplane to immigration and the air is thin and dry in Denver. The [Office of U.S. Customs and Border Protection](#) monitors average wait time per passenger going through Passport Control.

IN THE CITY

Sales tax

Most goods in the city have an 8.3% sales tax, in addition to the amount on the price tag.

Tipping/Gratuities

Tipping is expected in certain situations in the United States. In most cases, it is acceptable to tip in cash. Here are some tipping guidelines:

- Restaurant server: 15 percent to 20 percent of the total check.
- Read your receipt before tipping as some restaurants include gratuity in the total cost.
- Bartenders: 10 percent to 15 percent of the total tab.
- Hotel bellhops: \$1 to \$2 per piece of luggage.
- Hotel cleaning staff: \$2-\$5 per day.
- Parking valets: \$5.